IDF UNIT SHOWDOWN · חשיבה CHASHIVA

Think Tank

NO POINTS. JUST REAL TALK.

Name: Team:

Read the background with your team. Talk it over, then write what you think. There's no right answer: back up your opinion with a reason, and listen to people who disagree.

TOPIC 1

October 7, 2023

BACKGROUND

On October 7, 2023, the holiday of Simchat Torah, Hamas terrorists from Gaza attacked southern Israel. About 1,200 people were killed and 251 were taken hostage into Gaza: the deadliest day for Jews since the Holocaust. Within days, about 360,000 reservists reported for duty, some flying home from the United States. The war in Gaza that followed caused enormous loss of life and destruction there, and it is debated around the world. A ceasefire began in October 2025, and the living hostages came home.

> **Thousands of reservists showed up before they were even called. What makes people volunteer like that? Would you?**

WHAT I THINK, AND WHY

TOPIC 2

Should everyone serve?

BACKGROUND

For decades, ultra-Orthodox (Haredi) men who study Torah full-time were exempt from the draft. In June 2024, Israel's Supreme Court ruled that the government must draft them like everyone else. It's one of the biggest debates in Israel today.

> **Should full-time religious students be drafted?**

SOME SAY	OTHERS SAY
Everyone should share the burden equally, especially in wartime.	Torah study protects the Jewish people too, and army life clashes with a strictly religious life.

WHAT I THINK, AND WHY

TOPIC 3

Women in combat

BACKGROUND

Since a law passed in 2000, women can serve in many combat jobs: as pilots, in mixed battalions like Caracal, and in border-defense tank crews, which fought on October 7. Many infantry brigades are still for men only.

Should every unit be open to anyone who passes the tests?

SOME SAY	OTHERS SAY
Equal tests, equal chances: the best person should get the job.	Physical demands and each unit's needs should decide, not fairness alone.

WHAT I THINK, AND WHY

TOPIC 4

Drafted at 18

BACKGROUND

The United States ended its draft in 1973 and has an all-volunteer military. Israel still drafts most 18-year-olds, and many adults keep serving in the reserves for years.

If you lived in Israel, how would you feel about being drafted at 18? What would you gain, and what would you give up?

WHAT I THINK, AND WHY